



SESSION 4 — COACH

Conflict & Recovery

Having difficult conversations

COACH OBJECTIVE

Coaches teach players how to handle conflicts constructively. Conflict avoidance weakens teams; good conflict management makes teams stronger. Players practice direct, respectful communication.

COACH NOTE

Your role during conflicts: don't immediately solve it, but guide. Give space to both sides. Use the "I-message" technique: "I feel X when you do Y, I would like Z." Practice this yourself too.

ACTIVITIES**1 Recognizing conflict styles**

⌚ 10 min

Discuss 4 conflict styles: avoiding, attacking, giving in, collaborating. Ask: which do you recognize in yourself? Which is most effective for the team? (Answer: collaborating.)

2 Roleplay: difficult conversation

⌚ 15 min

Pairs act out a scenario: player A is upset with player B for always being late. Use the I-message structure. After 3 min: switch roles and discuss what worked.

3 Setting up a recovery protocol

⌚ 5 min

Together set up a short recovery protocol: what do you do after a conflict? (1) Cool down 24h. (2) Direct conversation, no third parties. (3) Coach as mediator if needed. (4) Restore the agreement.

NOTES



DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- How do you currently resolve conflicts within the team?
- What's the difference between a conflict that weakens the team and one that makes it stronger?
- When do you involve the coach and when do you solve it yourself?

CLOSING

Hang the recovery protocol next to the team contract. Explain: conflicts are normal — what matters is how you deal with them. Teams that process conflicts well are the strongest teams.

NOTES

"Peace is not the absence of conflict, but the presence of alternatives."

— Ronald Reagan